

CHAPTER FIVE

PART ONE

This next part will be devoted to the period of time that I was employed at the Central Intelligence Agency. The C.I.A. was chartered in 1947 and was an outgrowth of the Office of Strategic Services, the military intelligence component during World War II. Many of the officers who were with O.S.S. simply stayed on after the war and most all of them became the heads of divisions and branches in the new civilian intelligence service.

Upon receiving my clearance after many months of anxious waiting, we got in our old 1939 Buick and headed back to Shanks Village to pick up our belongings and to dispose of our rather meager furnishings. The trip back was pretty much like the one going to Utah, all kinds of problems with the car, primarily an engine that overheated so we coasted down hills so that the engine would cool off. Eventually we made it back to New York, sold our furniture and packed our car full of clothes, books and what have you and headed for Washington, D.C. somewhat apprehensive as to what we would encounter but at least glad to have some employment of a professional nature. Our trip to Washington was not without incident, however. In those days we had to cross the Delaware River on a ferry boat. We got on the ferry boat all right but when trying to get off, we found that the battery on the old Buick was about gone so we had to be pushed to get off the ferry boat. Such embarrassment one has to go through when you don't have any money. I reported for duty on October 23, 1950 as a GS-7, the general entry grade of people with at least a Master's degree. The pay was only \$3875 annually but at least it was a regular job. We found some temporary quarters on I St. right smack in the middle of Washington, D.C. in an area which was occupied primarily with blacks. It was convenient to transportation to work and we had already found us an apartment in Virginia which was under construction so we knew we wouldn't be camping for too long.

My initial assignments with the Agency were varied and, of course, I was intrigued with the secrecy of everything. We were just gearing up for a major intelligence effort against the Soviets from a base in Germany. By this date the Soviets had made it abundantly clear that they were going to pursue an expansionist policy, having already taken over much of eastern Europe. I was immediately put to work writing up the projects for utilization of Russian and other Soviet ethnic groups as targets for penetration of the Soviet Union. I wrote projects for the utilization of the N.T.S. (Nationalnaya Trudovaya Soyuz) an emigre organization of Great Russians. Many of the ethnic groups opposed to communism fled the Soviet Union during and after World War II, and the members of the N.T.S. consisted of a large group

of military age people who had taken advantage of the opportunity to get out of a totalitarian regime. They represented a tremendous pool of highly-motivated people who were interested in doing anything they could to overthrow the oppressive leaders of the Soviet nation. The projects which I wrote contained not only the operational objectives, such as how, when, where, and why the organization was to be used, but also the financial particulars, including the budgetary estimates, schedules of payments, and methods for effecting payments, all of which was supposed to be done in a clandestine manner. Other organizations utilized were the Belorussian national groups, Lithuanians, Latvians, Estonians, and Ukrainians, all of whom had their own nationalistic interests to pursue. In most cases the operational objectives were to obtain personnel through these organizations who would serve as agents for penetration into the Soviet Union and who would be trained and controlled by the U.S. intelligence service. Also, these groups were used as propaganda vehicles through various media techniques, such as newspapers, periodicals, and radio broadcasts to influence public policy.

While the foregoing was the major part of my function as an assistant to the branch chief, I was also involved in another very interesting project for which I had personal responsibility. This was a project to procure former PT boats to serve as a means of infiltration into the Soviet Union from its various peripheries. In order to do this it was necessary to work through an effective cutout (a person or organization which could not be identified as buying for the U.S. government). We used a retired naval Captain who had extensive contacts and who set up a corporation ostensibly to buy used PT boats for wealthy clients who wanted to use them as pleasure craft (since the building of yachts and vessels like that had been terminated because of the war.) It was my responsibility, in addition to the handling of all the administrative and budgetary aspects of the project, to oversee the purchase and overhauling of these craft for our particular purpose. The project was budgeted for several million dollars and if we needed more all I had to do was write up a supplementary request.

The object of the overhaul was to make the craft superfast for high speed crossings of certain waters peripheral to the Soviet Union, such as the Black and Baltic Seas. Many of the decisions as to what and how to do it were left up to me, which was ironical because my naval experience had been confined mostly to naval schools and work as an electronic technician on an aircraft carrier. After the PT boats were equipped to our specifications, I had to arrange to ship them to various staging areas in as secure manner as possible to avoid detection of their existence and especially their intended use for intelligence purposes. This was done primarily in coordination with

naval intelligence. Another important aspect of this project was in making arrangements for the recruitment of third national crews to man the converted PT boats since they obviously couldn't be manned by American personnel. Consequently, I had to devise a project for field personnel to recruit, train, and fund agents for this purpose. All in all, a total of about six converted PT boats were shipped to various parts of the world, such as the Baltic, Black Sea, and the Far East.

Concurrent with the PT procurment program, I was also responsible for managing from headquarters, the staging of the clandestine aircraft operating out of southern Europe into Germany and then into the Soviet Union. My job was to arrange with the U.S. Air Force for logistical handling of the two aircraft, before, during and after a clandestine flight. One can best appreciate the significance of my work in just the air and maritime fields by the fact that upon my departure for the field (Germany) in June of 1952, my projects became the responsibility of an entire division in the Clandestine Services. This division was headed by a retired Rear-Admiral, another Naval officer, two Air Force colonels, and several senior (GS 12-GS 14) civilians. I never had the heart to tell the Rear Admiral (who was once a flag officer on the U.S.S. Wasp) that I had only been an enlisted man in the Navy. In our conversations, he always had to refer to the capability of "we former Navy officers" to switch our talents to civilian activities.

During the almost two years we spent in Washington, D.C. area before going overseas, we attended the Falls Church ward of the then Washington Stake which covered all of Virginia, Maryland, and a part of Pennsylvania. Marion and I co-taught a Sunday School class (the ten year olds-which was a good way to find out what went on in members homes). By this time Marion was pregnant with our second child, Gail, who was born on June 30, 1951. What a difference a couple of years makes! When Ron was born Marion was kept in the hospital for about ten days, with Gail she was home in two or three days. I was in a carpool with another CIA man, Hugh Fleischer. It was my turn to drive on June 30th so when Marion started in labor in the morning I called Hugh, picked him up at his home, drove him into the office (the Clandestine Services were located in some WWI type converted barracks called I, J, K and L buildings along side the reflecting pool near the Lincoln Memorial), then drove Marion to Arlington Hospital. The doctor was anxiously awaiting us, having been called before we left home. It was a good thing too because Gail was born in about a half-hour after we arrived at the hospital.

Of course, we had long since moved into the Willston apartments at Seven Corners in Falls Church, Virginia. Initially we occupied a one bedroom apartment on one of the upper floors which cost us \$88.00 a month rent, but with the birth of Gail we were able to obtain a two bedroom apartment on the ground floor. A few weeks after Gail was born, I received a frantic telephone call from Marion saying that Gail had been dropped by her brother and his little friend and was really banged up. When I got to the doctor's office she looked pretty bad, but the healing power of infants is great, within a few days one could barely tell anything had happened to her. We were fortunate in these early days in the Washington area to be close to Marion's two sisters, Edith and Mildred and their families, both of whom lived in the Arlington area. They helped us a lot in making the transition from the academic to the professional public service world.

After much travail with our old 1939 Buick and getting promotions regularly, we bought a little Studebaker called a Starlite coupe, which we enjoyed very much. In June 1952, my assignment to the field came through. It was to the Combined Soviet Operations Base in Munich, Germany. After leaving our apartment and getting our furniture packed for shipment overseas, we drove to Utah and California for a vacation. While in California, in addition to visiting relatives, Ila, Martin, Loverna and their families, I took the opportunity to call on my old college chum, Bill Gay, who was by then the Chief of Staff for Howard Hughes, a very impressive position with a lot of power. He suggested that I might want to work for him when I returned from overseas.

PART TWO

The housing situation overseas, particularly in Germany, was pretty bad so I had to go to the field ahead of my family to await the time when housing would be available. I returned to Washington driving our little coupe with a young couple and their child who needed transportation to that area, while Marion and the two children stayed with her family in Provo. I arrived in Germany in early August and lived in a bachelor apartment in McGraw Kasern until mid-September when Marion arrived with Ronald and Gail, after traveling via train and airplane from Provo, a big task in those days. We lived temporarily in a small apartment of an officer who was on home leave (Al Galcius) until our furniture arrived when we moved to a house at Sabineschmidt Str. 12, one of many German quarters taken over by the allied occupation forces. Ron was only three and a half at the time and was awfully glad to see toys and household furniture which he could recognize.

We attended a German branch of the church, although after sacrament services, the Americans attended classes

which were conducted in English. The German saints were still suffering a lot as a result of the war and didn't have much in terms of assets but they were very generous. On one occasion, shortly after we arrived, we were at a branch dinner and the only thing being served was a weisswurst, a large white sausage, filled with gristle and fat. I managed to choke mine down as did Marion but there was no way we could get our young children to do so. Of course, this went over like a lead balloon with the Germans who felt fortunate to have anything to eat at all. There were a lot of L.D.S servicemen in Munich and we became close friends with many of them. One of them, Robert Bolinder, married a German girl named Gertrude. He later became the president and C.E.O of the Albertson's food chain operating out of Boise, Idaho. We also took advantage of the sight-seeing available to us, being right in the midst of beautiful Bavaria and close to the Austrian alps and the famous ski resorts of southern Germany such as Garmisch.

My operational and supervisory activities in Munich came under the auspices of what was known as the Combined Soviet Operations Base (i.e a combination of the Office of Special Operations and the Office of Policy Coordination, latter being a fancy word for psychological warfare and political propaganda). It was headed by Harry Rositzke, my former division chief in the States, with David E. Murphy as his deputy, latter having been my branch chief in Washington. The main function of this base was to launch clandestine operations into the Soviet Union and the Eastern European countries, although most of the latter took place from the Berlin base. This was done by whatever means one could devise, overland, air drop, or sea infiltration. Mostly, we were involved in the recruitment and training of agents to be air-dropped into the Soviet Union much as agents had been sent in during World War II to try to recruit partisan groups inside the target country. My particular responsibility was to work with dissident ethnic groups such as the Belorussians, Ukrainians, and Lithuanians. I was a section chief, with responsibility for the supervision of approximately 12-14 other officers, as well as running my own operations, principally with the BNR (the Belorussian National Republic) leaders and the people they could manage to recruit to return to their homeland and try to set up a base of operations there. I had been promoted to GS-11 while still in Washington (about the equivalent of an Army captain) and early in 1954 was promoted to grade GS-12 (roughly equivalent to a Major.)

I tried to maintain a clandestine relationship with a variety of high-level officials of dissident emigre groups, such as the president and his chief operating officer of the Belorussian National Republic in exile, certain Lithuanian leaders, also in exile, many of whom were former cabinet officers in the legitimate government of Lithuania before it

was invaded by the Soviets (e.g. the ministers of foreign affairs, finance and agriculture). It was difficult to keep things on a clandestine basis since their national pride would not permit the type of relationship traditional in the intelligence business. I remember on one occasion driving to Regensburg to meet my Lithuanian contacts, only to find that they had arranged a luncheon for all their associates to meet me. To them I was just a representative of the U. S. Government who was the source of funding for some of the activities which they wanted to run themselves but didn't have the where-with-all or know-how to do. I'm sure that situations of this type resulted in my name being on the roster of the K.G.B. early in my career.

We took advantage of the fact that we were living in Europe to do as much sightseeing as possible. There were a lot of beautiful lakes and villages close to Munich and Austria was just a couple of hours drive on the autobahn. Lake Tegernsee and Lake Chiemsee were especially nice to visit as was the famous ski resort areas of the Alps, Garmisch-Partenkirchen where the winter Olympics were held at one time before WWII, I believe in 1936. While my weekday workdays were very long, I did manage to get away for short trips with the family on weekends and holidays. My first trip away from Munich was an operational one which required me to go to Brussels in November 1952 to consult on an operational activity involving our station there, since it was in Brussels that the B.N.R. maintained its headquarters. About all I really remember about that trip was how cold it was in Brussels being, as it is, very close to the English Channel. Marion and I also managed to get away for a few days to visit with Peter and Mary Brescia in Nurnberg, the home of Nazism. Peter was in my graduating class of the Columbia University School of International Affairs. He was in the State Department assigned to Nurnberg as a HICOG representative (High Commissioner for Germany). It was very interesting to see some of the places where Hitler had first consolidated his rise to power.

Christmas in Munich was quite an event for us, our first in Germany, and the home of so many of our Christmas carols such as O Tannenbaum (Oh, Christmas Tree). The Germans were still valiantly trying to recover from the war so most of them didn't have much but one could feel the Christmas spirit very much and , of course, the cold weather and snow helped in that regard. We did most of our shopping in the Post Exchange (the PX) since prices were so much better for us. The exchange rate between the dollar and the Deutschmark was four to one and strictly controlled although it was not representative of the mark's true value, which was closer to 4.25 to one dollar. I recall going to the PX with Ron and buying a clock for Marion, only to have him announce when we got home that Daddy had told him that he wasn't supposed to tell her that we had bought her a clock for Christmas.

In early February 1953, Orin and Rita Parker came to visit us. They were stationed in Athens, Greece with an organization known as AFME (American Friends of the Middle East). Rita was pregnant and did not want to nor was it recommended that she have a baby in a hospital in Athens so they had arranged to have the birth take place in Germany where she could have the attention of the Army Field hospital located in Munich. We had known the Parkers for many years. Rita was from Idaho Falls, Idaho and was in the same ward as I was. My sister, Ila, used to babysit her on occasion. Orin and Rita were both at B.Y.U. with us, in many of the same clubs and organizations and Orin and I graduated from B.Y.U. in the same graduating class. Time dragged on the pregnancy as it frequently does with the first child and Orin had some business to conduct in some other city, I believe it was Vienna. Of course, while he was away was just the time that young Jeff decided to make his entrance into the world, so Marion and I ended up rushing Rita to the 98th Field Hospital a few hours before Orin was scheduled to return. He got a message at the airport to go directly to the hospital where his wife was having a baby, which also happened to be Marion's birthday, February 12th. Quite a way to celebrate one's birthday.

It was during the winter of 1952-1953 that we were able to make our first trip to Garmisch and visit by cable car the famous Zugspitz, a towering mountain peak from which one could see part of the Austrian, Swiss and Italian Alps. We also managed a short trip to Oberammergau, the site of the world-famous passion play (held every ten years and this wasn't the year, however). We also took a quick trip to Heidelberg with a few of the servicemen who were in the Munich L.D.S. group. We had the advantage of having a car available to us, something which was still quite a luxury in Germany in the early fifties, although there were already quite a few Volkswagen beetles running around , affordable only to a limited number of the German people. Gasoline was also at a premium. We were allocated so much through the military Post Exchange system and it was very inexpensive compared to what the Germans had to pay for the limited supply on the open market, about 25 cents per gallon as I recall.

PART THREE

After a winter of extensive operational activity, primarily training and preparing for infiltration by air into the Soviet Union, many groups of the emigre recruits which I mentioned earlier, I finally was able to take a real vacation with Marion and another couple, Marvin and Gayla Green. Marvin Green was an Army captain and one of

the L.D.S. chaplains assigned to the large military contingent in Munich, the headquarters for the Southern Area Command. Our car, the Starlite coupe, wasn't very big but we loaded our luggage plus as many five gallon containers of gasoline as we could into its trunk and took off for Italy on April 29, 1953 with a lot of snow still on the ground in Germany and Austria but after we passed through the Brenner Pass and into the Italian Alps and down into Italy, the weather was spring-like. We arrived in Venice, hired a gondola taxi, and was greeted when we reached the Metropole Hotel with a literal red carpet being rolled down the steps right to the edge of the gondola. Our visit covered all the usual sights Venice, St. Mark's Cathedral, the Palace of the Doges (dukes), the Bridge of Sighs, and Lido beach.

From Venice we drove to Florence, arriving there on April 30th. The next morning we woke up to a tremendous noise in the plaza below where there was a huge crowd for a political demonstration. Only then did it occur to us that it was May Day, the traditional Labor Day in Europe and the day on which most of the leftist groups show their political muscle. In Florence, we visited many of the famous art galleries since by this time most of the paintings taken from them during the war had been returned and were available again for viewing by the public. Evidence of wartime damage to some of the Italian cities was quite apparent, however. We then headed for Rome, stopping enroute to see the tower of Pisa. In Rome we stayed at the Victoria Hotel and in a few short days visited the Roman Forum, the Colosseum, the Catacombs where the early Christians secreted themselves, the Roman baths, the Pantheon, and, of course, the famous St. Peter's cathedral, the Vatican museum, and the Sistine chapel to see Michaelangelo's famous paintings.

After Rome, we traveled to Livorno (Leghorn) to resupply our gasoline at the PX there, then spent two days at Viareggio on the Tyrrhenian Sea, even braving the cold water to get a little bit of the feel of the ocean. We stopped for some sight-seeing in Genoa, principally to see its famous cathedral and the statue of Christopher Columbus (who was a Genoese). We returned via the Swiss Alps where it was still winter, stopping at a delightful pension in Silvaplana not far from St. Moritz, where we had a plateful of steaks served family style and comforters on our beds with about six inches of down in them. That night, however, because the temperature was quite a bit below freezing, I had to drain the water from the car.

One of our short trips was to Vienna, Austria for which one had to receive permission since it involved traveling through the Soviet Zone of East Germany on a special train. Once on board it took a long time getting started because someone's passport was out of order. It turned out to be Marion's, which, of course, wasn't out of

order at all, except that someone had just neglected to put down one of the zeroes which preceded the actually number. The Soviets typically using any sort of excuse to try to frustrate the Americans. Our visit to this fabulous city was exciting and in a couple of days we saw the opera house, St. Stephan's cathedral, the Capuchen church and the Hapsburg tombs, Schoenbrunn Palace, the wine gardens of Grunzing, the home of Beethoven, and statues of such reknown composers as Mozart, Straus, and Haydn.

One weekend in July (July 11-12) we drove to Landshut for the reenactment of the Royal wedding (Hochzeit) between George of Landshut, Bavaria and Hedwig, a Polish princess, which took place in 1475. Everything was made as authentic as possible, the carriage for the bride and groom, the costumes, the entertainment and the food. There was a festival ground with knights engaged in tilting and lance fighting, and some delicious 15th century barbecued fish. Some of the people who were with us on this trip were servicemen Evan Judd and Ed Speight, Dale and Marie Gray (an army dentist) and the Wierdt's (Charlotte and Leonard, a non-member Air Force colonel). Also took a quick trip to the Bodensee (Lake Constance) to Lindau, Ulm and the castle at Neu Schwanstein, and went to see the violin makers at Mittenwald.

The dictator of the Soviet Union, Joseph V. Stalin, died in early 1953 and we anticipated that his death would cause some changes if not an upheaval in the Soviet Union. This was true to a certain extent but it did not occur as rapidly as we thought it might. Our operational activity of infiltrating the U.S.S.R continued although we were experiencing a lot of failures. The control of the K.G.B was so extensive that almost all, and eventually all, of the teams that we sent in were compromised. We had managed to maintain WT contact with some of them but in spite of that contact we always had to consider the possibility that they had come under hostile control. When it served their purposes the Soviets would publish in Pravda the accounts of the arrest, trial and often the execution of the "spies" that the U. S. Intelligence Service had sent in to subvert their citizens. Much of this, of course, was to discourage other people from being recruited to send in. It did have its effects although, to their credit, there were still some highly motivated young men who would knowingly risk their lives on operations which they knew were extremely hazardous. In the summer of 1953 the citizens of East Berlin made a valiant effort to throw off their Soviet yoke. But it was fruitless without the help of the West. President Eisenhower, who had just been elected the previous November on the platform of ending the Korean conflict, just wouldn't take the steps to provide the aid that was needed. He would not risk the possibility of hostilities with the Soviets, especially since the Korean War was still going on although in its final stages.

We spent another Christmas in Munich in 1953, much more accustomed to the weather and the people. I bought Ronnie an HO gauge train for a present, although he was still pretty young but his dad and his dad's friends certainly had a good time with it. We had continued doing all the visiting that we could, including a visit to the concentration camp at Dachau, on the outskirts of Munich, a very sobering experience. Our maid, Lee, had been the wife of a former SS officer and she, like most Germans, claimed complete ignorance of the existence of such a concentration camp. Maybe so, it is difficult to know where the truth lies.

Our overseas tours were not without problems. As one could expect Americans abroad were always fair targets for theft and burglary and one night we had our sterling silver stolen while we were asleep in the house. Although, we remain unconvinced that our maid, Lee, didn't have something to do with providing information to the thieves, we came out of the affair in good shape. The insurance company reimbursed us for the full value of the silver service which we had received as a wedding present. With that money we bought a larger service at the PX of a different pattern which we never used while in Germany since the military furnished silver service with the houses. When we returned to Virginia we were able to exchange the International pattern with the Wallace Rose Point we had previously owned plus additional place settings which we didn't have before.

Our family planning continued and we found out late in 1953 that Marion was pregnant. Since the baby was due in March 1954 we took some trips while Marion was expecting even though the weather conditions were not the best. In early 1954 we took a train instead of driving to Paris to see the sights there. It was a bitter cold winter, the coldest that Europe had experienced in 75 years so we kept pretty well bundled up and inside as much as we could. However, we saw the usual Paris sights, such as the Eiffel Tower, Notre Dame, Napoleon's tomb, and Maxim's and enjoyed the French cuisine very much. Our hotel room had just one tiny radiator so we took hot baths to keep warm when we were not out seeing the town. I almost lost my camera there, leaving it at a restaurant and grabbing a taxi to the railroad station. Fortunately, there was a little time left so I got a taxi to take me back, pick up the camera and still make it before the departure time.

Our third child was born on March 17, 1954. There seemed to be no other choice but to call her Patricia, being St. Patrick's day, and also the birthday of several of her uncles. The trip to the 98th General on a cold winter morning very early was uneventful although somewhat hazardous and Marion delivered without any problems. Since

we had a new maid by this time, by the name of Isolde, it was much easier for Marion than on the births of the other two children. We blessed Patty at the Munich branch on the first Sunday in May, 1954. In the spring of 1954 I had been promoted to the grade of GS-12. Economically things were much better since, in addition to the increased income, our housing was provided for us.

In May after Marion had regained all of her strength we took a trip by car to Heidleberg, Cologne, and on into Belgium and Holland. We went across the channel to England and were able to spend a few days with our friends, the Mabey's, whom we knew from BYU, and who were doing graduate study at Oxford. We visited the usual things, tower of London, London bridge, etc. and were able to take in some of the theatrical plays such as "The King and I". We were there on the occasion of the return of the Queen and her husband from a six month round the world tour of the dwindling British Empire, although we didn't see them since we opted instead to see a play, something which amazed some of the English people who don't quite understand Americans and their lack of concern for royalty. On our way home we stopped to see the famous "Nuts" monument at Bastogne, France where Gen. McAullife rendered that remark to the Germans during the Battle of the Bulge when they wanted him to surrender his position.

Shortly, after our return to Munich I was able to obtain the address in Zurich of my first cousin, Anna, so during the Memorial Day weekend, May 29-31, Marion and I and two of our children, Ron and Gail, drove to Zurich and had a delightful visit with the members of my Mother's family who were still alive in Switzerland, including besides Anna and her husband, Karl, my cousin Rudolf and wife, and my Uncle Rudolf, the only remaining member of Mother's immediate family. They even managed, during the short time we were there, to make up a small photo album of our visit with pictures of all the members of the family.

Since our time was growing short, we squeezed in a couple of other visits that we wanted to make, such as a trip to Rothenburg, a thousand-year old city, which retained much of its original charm, such as the city walls and tiled roofs. We saw the traditional Shepherd's Dance just as it was performed ten centuries ago. We were especially delighted to visit the city of Salzburg in Austria, just a few hours drive along the Autobahn from Munich.

During the latter part of 1954 it became increasingly apparent that we had to change our operational tactics vis a vis the Soviets. Many significant events had taken place in Europe and the Soviet Union, not the least of which was the death of Stalin and the subsequent cult of personality which Krushchev and some of the other old line Bolsheviks tried to

continue. I found during the last few months that I was being asked to do a variety of tasks outside of my regular operational sphere of interest such as maintaining liaison with the American Committee for the Liberation of Europe (AMCOMBLIB) then a CIA-sponsored entity. Our World War II infiltration tactics just weren't successful. In one way or another all the agents we sent in by air, sea or land were compromised and the results weren't worth the efforts. Also, with Krushchev, the Soviet Union was gradually opening up so that a few people could travel legally into it.

PART FOUR

After several farewell parties, one of which was given by a delightful L.D.S. couple named Bob and Grace Douglass (He was an Army dentist and she was from So. Africa), we were on our way home. We had booked passage on the new superliner, the S.S. United States, and traveled to Paris, being able to have a brief layover in Zurich enroute where we saw Anna and Karl again at the airport. After a few days of sightseeing in Paris with the family, we took the boat-train to LeHavre to board the ship. Our crossing was quite uneventful, the North Atlantic being quite cold and gusty even though it was August, but we enjoyed the relaxation and the sea air and Ron and Gail were at least old enough to appreciate the luxury of the travel. Patty, of course, was less than six months old and still had to be fed a special formula because she was allergic to regular milk.

After our arrival and disembarkation in New York, the family separated. I had to go to Headquarters in Washington, D.C. to check in before going on home leave. Marion took the children on the airplane for what she thought was going to be a short flight to Kansas City where Helen and Jay Jepps were located (Jay still being in dental school). As it turned out their plane developed some trouble and had to put down in Pittsburgh where Marion struggled with the two older children and a young baby for several hours with very inadequate facilities, before continuing on to K.C. Of course, I was blissfully unaware of their predicament, having taken a short flight to Washington, D.C., checked in at Headquarters, bought a new Ford 2 door sedan and took off to join my family.

We divided our home leave between Utah and California, going to the latter to visit Ila and Howard, Martin and Betty and Lovern and her family as well as give our kids a chance to see the beach. In late September we started our return trip to the Washington D.C. area not knowing where we were going to live but anxious to return and try to buy us a house, having saved up some money while overseas for this purpose. We took an apartment in Glassmanor, an apartment complex in Maryland, within fairly easy commuting distance of my work, (the offices still being

located along the reflecting pool by the Lincoln Memorial)). From there we began our search for a new house. Typically, the prices were higher than we had been led to believe, but eventually we found one that we liked in a new development called Franconia Estates, just a few miles from Alexandria, Virginia. The price for the house was \$18,500 plus closing costs on a V.A. loan, at 4.5% interest, about three or four thousand more than we ever thought we would have to pay, but as it turned out a very good investment for us. We moved into the house at 905 Sable Drive in late November, 1954. It was a split-level house with three small bedrooms, living room, dining room, kitchen, and a den downstairs by the laundry room, as well as a two car garage.

We immediately became active in the Alexandria Ward of the then Washington Stake where we met in a school building while a new chapel was being constructed on King St. in Alexandria. Most of our spare time was spent in working on the many finishing phases of the chapel, principally doing painting and staining of woodwork. Wendell Thorne was the Bishop of the ward. Upon completion of the chapel, it was dedicated on June 19, 1955 by Ezra Taft Benson, a member of the Quorum of the Twelve, who also was the Secretary of Agriculture in the Eisenhower administration. In August the bishopric was reorganized and the new Bishop, Joe Dunn, an FBI agent, chose me as his second counselor- much to my surprise since we had only been in the Ward since the previous November. I was ordained a High Priest by Ezra Taft Benson on August 7, 1955, making my priesthood line of authority as follows:

Virgil Lehi Harris...ordained a High Priest by Ezra Taft Benson, 7 August 1955.

Ezra Taft Benson...ordained an Apostol by Heber J. Grant, Oct. 7, 1943.

Heber J. Grant...ordained an Apostol by George Q. Cannon, Oct. 16, 1882.

George Q. Cannon...ordained an Apostol by Brigham Young, Aug. 26, 1860.

Brigham Young...ordained an Apostol by the Three Witnesses of the Book of Mormon (Oliver Cowdery, David Whitmer, and Martin Harris), Feb. 14, 1835.

The Three Witnesses were called by divine revelation to select and ordain the first twelve apostols of the restored Church and were set apart for this purpose by the First Presidency of the Church (Joseph Smith, Frederick G. Williams, and Sidney Rigdon) on Feb. 14, 1845. Joseph Smith, Jr...was ordained an Apostol by Peter, James, and John (D.&C.27:12) ordained by Jesus Christ, sent from God.